

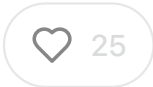
How to build Onboarding HR Agent with Claude

I built an onboarding HR Assistant twice. Once in Claude, once in Lovable. Here's how to choose which one to reach for and when.



THE CHRO OFFICE

MAY 28, 2026 • PAID



READ TIME: 8 MINUTES

For most of my career, an HR leader who wanted a tool had exactly one path.

You wrote the ticket. You explained the idea to someone in engineering who had never run an onboarding cycle in their life. You waited while it sat in a backlog behind revenue projects. Six months later you got back something that almost did what you asked, and by then the process had already changed.

So most HR teams stopped asking.

They ran onboarding out of a spreadsheet and a Google Doc and a calendar reminder because the cost of getting a real tool built was higher than the pain of doing it by hand.

Every CHRO reading this has lived some version of that. The idea you knew would help your team is parked forever because it was never worth an engineer's quarter.

That math just broke.

Today an HR leader can describe a tool in plain English and watch it get built for them in an afternoon. No ticket or backlog.

ACME SOFTWARE

Onboarding Assistant

New Hire

[Checklist](#) [Help](#)

Your onboarding progress

0 of 13 tasks

FILTER BY PEOPLE INVOLVED

Team/Department Lead 7

HR Team 6

IT 2

Office Admin 2

1 Pre-Boarding Before Day 1

+ ADD TASK HERE



#1

Send Welcome Email

🕒 1 week before start date 👤 HR Team

*Initiate early engagement by welcoming the new hire and outlining what to expect before Day 1.*

🕒 TIMING & DURATION

1 week before start date

1 day

👤 PEOPLE INVOLVED

HR Team

📌 ACTION ITEMS

Send welcome email with onboarding checklist and Day 1 overview

📦 DELIVERABLES

Welcome email
Onboarding checklist

+ ADD TASK HERE



#2

Set Up Access and Equipment

🕒 1 week before start date 👤 IT



+ ADD TASK HERE



#3

Prepare Welcome Kit

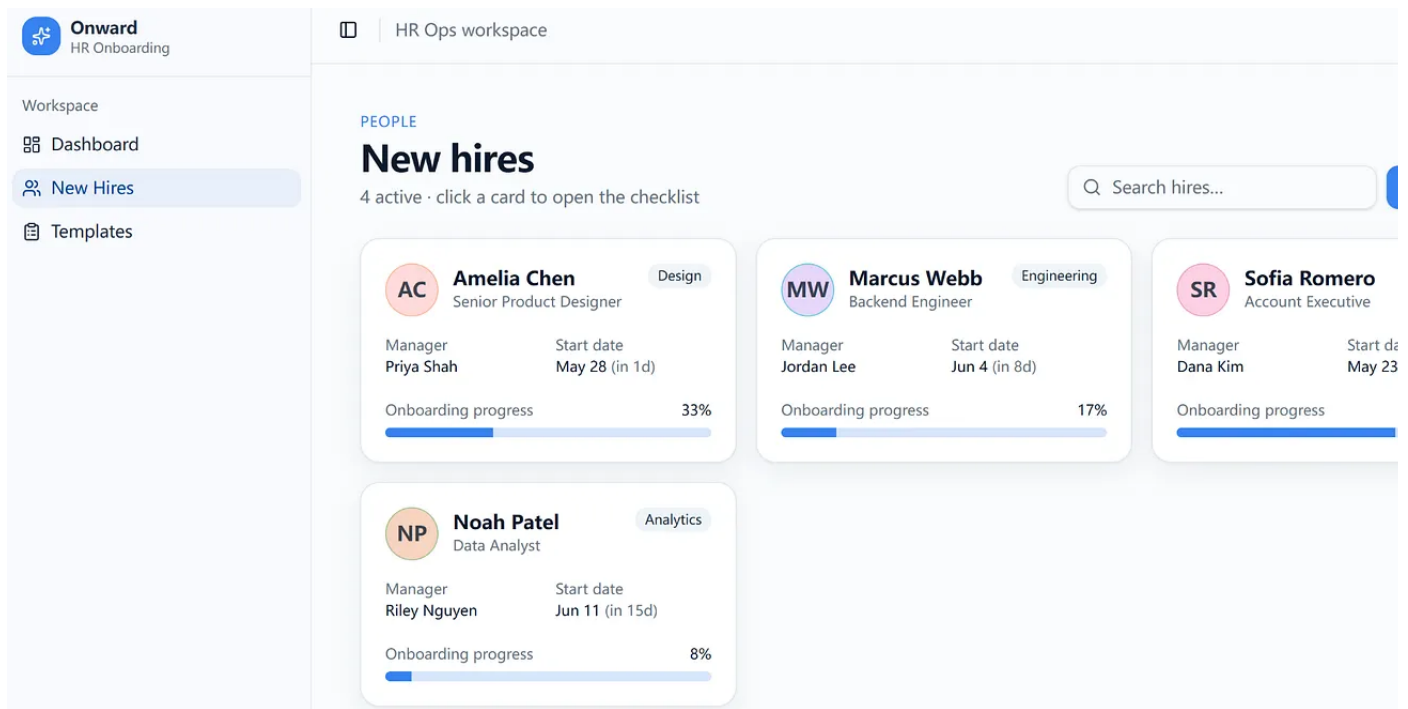
🕒 3-4 days before start date 👤 Office Admin



You talk, the tool changes, and you ship it.

The question is no longer whether HR can build its own tools.

It is which tool you build with, and what you can realistically expect when you



So I ran a real test.

I picked one of the most universal HR jobs there is, **new hire onboarding**, and an onboarding agent twice.

Once in Claude. Once in Lovable. Same opening prompt. Same uploaded onboarding materials. Same picture in my head of what the finished thing should do.

Then I watched where each one pulled ahead, where each one hit a wall, and where neither of them can do no matter how good your prompts are.

Here is what I learned and how a CHRO can pick between them.

Let's dive in.

Building Onboarding Agent in Claud

I opened with a single line:

Who is the primary user of this tool?

< 1 of 2

1

New hires (they're the main users)

2

HR Ops team (you configure it, new hires don't see it)

3

Both — new hires use it, HR Ops configures it



Something else

COPY/PASTE Prompt

I'm in HR Ops, and I want to build a tool for new hire onboarding here.

In past editions I have made the case that a longer, more specific prompt gets stronger result. For a build like this you would normally load the prompt with everything. The goal. The users. The must-have features. The full workflow.

This time I did the opposite. One line.

Which features matter most? (pick up to 3)

< 2 of 2

☒ Chat Q&A about company policies/benefits

☒ Onboarding checklist tracker (Day 1, Week 1, Month 1)

☒ Document/form explainer (I-9, W-4, benefits forms)

☐ Welcome email/message generator

☐ Manager-side view (track new hire's progress)

☐ Buddy/mentor matching

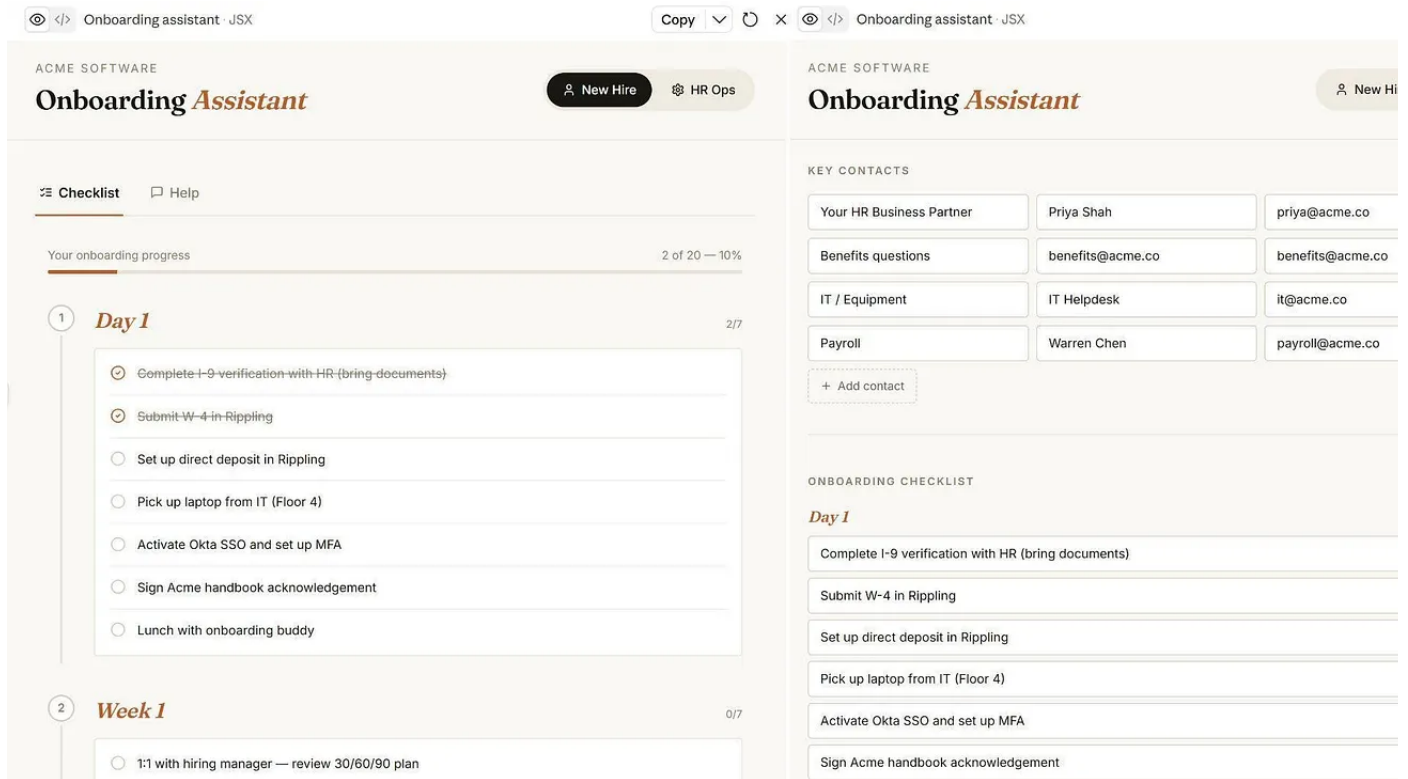
☐ Something else

3 selected

Skip

Here is the thinking. New hire onboarding is one of the most common HR fun on the planet. Claude already knows what it is. Starting short and letting it ask you what it actually understands before you start steering. If it scopes the build off one line, that tells you how much it already carries.

Claude came back with two scoping questions. I answered them in a sentence started building.



The V1 prototype had two views. One for the new hire, with a checklist and a panel for their questions. One for HR Ops, with company info, key contacts, a checklist settings.

It was plain. The design was rough. But every feature I asked for was there, and at that point on I could shape the entire thing by talking to it.

I refined it over a few rounds. I uploaded our current onboarding checklist and Claude to fold it in. A few of the prompts I sent:

This is our current onboarding flow. Review it carefully and incorporate it into the existing Onboarding Assistant.

Add Up and Down arrows to each task box so users can reorder the sequence.

Let users add tasks between existing tasks, since steps vary case by case. Add an Edit button for each task.

Too many groups under "People Involved." Consolidate into Team/Department Lead, HR Team, IT, and Office Admin. Add a filter at the top.

Where it landed: a far richer checklist. Each task carried timing, duration, people involved, action items, and deliverables. Every step expanded for detail, reordered with arrow controls, or edited in place. An "Add Task Here" button sat between every task. For the ad hoc tasks a specific hire needs.

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Set Up Access and Equipment

🕒 1 week before start date 👤 IT



+ ADD TASK HERE



#3

Prepare Welcome Kit

🕒 3-4 days before start date 👤 Office Admin



What worked

You never start from a blank page. Claude already understands what an HR to

name it, it asks the right scoping questions, and you skip writing a spec document to begin.

You watch the tool change as you talk. Your chat sits on the left, the live tool on the right. Every instruction updates the tool in front of you, so you verify each change at the spot instead of waiting for a review cycle.

It follows instructions cleanly. Across every tweak, I never had to repeat myself or translate into engineering terms. Plain HR language was enough.

The output is shareable. The tool publishes as a live link you can send inside the company or to an outside partner. It also exports as a code file your engineer can pick up later.

Where it breaks

It builds the front end, not the full system. Claude builds what users see and the underlying machinery that turns a prototype into a real product, stores data over time, logs in, and lets teams collaborate lives behind the scenes and cannot be created from inside a chat window.

Handing it to engineering is not one click. Even with engineers and existing systems, the exported code does not plug straight in. Someone has to read it, repackage it, and wire it up, and that work takes longer than the building did.

Build Onboarding Agent with Lovable

[Lovable](#) is a Stockholm-based AI app builder launched in 2024. You describe what you want in plain language and it generates a working application end to end.

I gave it the exact same opening line to see how it would react:

I'm in HR Ops, and I want to build a tool for new hire onboarding here.

Like Claude, it asked clarifying questions before building. It also offered a “Write your own” option.

The questions went further than Claude’s. Lovable asked about features and workflow and then about visual design too.

The screenshot shows a web interface for a new hire onboarding tool. At the top, a question asks, "What's the core workflow you want this tool to handle for new hires?" with a "Select multiple" link. Below this is a list of five options, each with a radio button and a description:

- ☒ **Task checklists per new hire**
Assign onboarding tasks (paperwork, IT setup, training) and track completion
- ☐ **Document collection**
Collect signed forms, IDs, tax docs from new hires
- ☐ **Schedule & intros**
First-week schedule, team intros, meeting setup
- ☐ **HR admin dashboard**
Overview of all new hires, status, bottlenecks
- ☐ Write your own...

At the bottom left, there are navigation arrows "<" and ">". At the bottom right, there is a "Skip all" button.

The V1 prototype came back noticeably more polished. At first glance it already looked like a finished product. Three tabs: Dashboard, New Hires, and Templates.

Four sample new hires are already populated, each with progress tracked. The new hire view showed manager, start date, and overall progress at a glance. The Templates

tab held the full checklist. Colors, layout, and design were all in place.

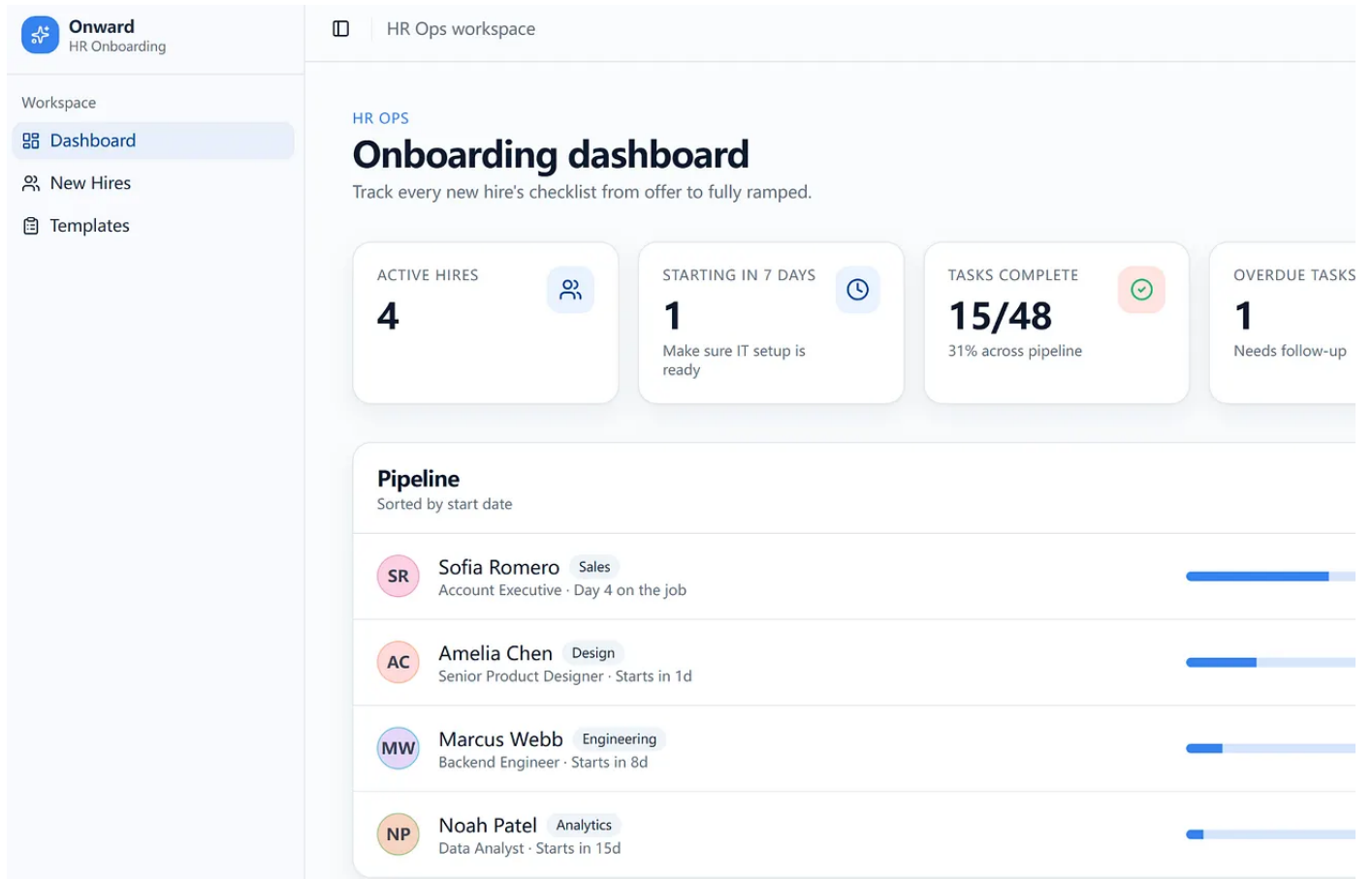
Pick a visual direction.

Write your own...

< >

Skip all

Compared to Claude, Lovable brought a deeper sense of what a mature onboarding product looks like out of the gate, likely because it has been shaped by more examples of finished HR software.



I sent the same refinement prompts I had used with Claude. I had to stop part through. I had burned the five daily credits Lovable gives free users.

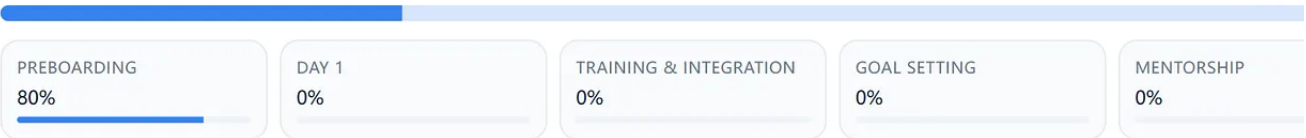
← All hires



Amelia Chen Design
Senior Product Designer

✉ amelia.chen@acme.co 👤 Manager: Priya Shah 📅 Thu, May 28 📅 Starts in 1 days

Overall progress 4 / 14 steps



- All
- Preboarding
- Day 1
- Training & Integration
- Goal Setting
- Mentorship

Preboarding 4/5

- ☒

Step 1 ~~Send Welcome Email~~ Done

Initiate early engagement by welcoming the new hire and outlining what to expect before Day 1.

🕒 1 week before start date ⌚ Duration: 1d 👤 HR Team (Ops and TA)

▼ Action items & deliverables
- ☐

Step 2 New step 6d overdue

Describe this step.

🕒 1 week before start date ⌚ Duration: 1d 👤 HR Team (Ops and TA)

▼ Action items & deliverables

New Hire Onboarding Methodology

New Hire Onboarding is a strategic process designed to integrate new employees effectively. It covers activities that help new hires understand their roles, company culture, and tools they need to succeed. A well-structured onboarding process enhances engagement, reduces turnover, and accelerates productivity — contributing directly to organizational success.

Key Questions

Successful onboarding depends on structured planning, cross-team coordination, and alignment with culture and performance goals.



Onboarding Objectives & Alignment

- What are the key goals of onboarding — engagement, compliance, productivity, or all?
- Have leaders aligned on success metrics for onboarding?
- How will onboarding integrate with broader talent and retention strategies?



Content & Resource Preparation

- Are materials up-to-date, accessible, and tailored to roles?
- Is technology (e.g., onboarding portals) retested?
- Are checklists, policies, and training schedules prepared?



Stakeholder Roles & Logistics

- Who owns each onboarding step — HR, manager, IT, mentor?
- Are workspaces, systems, and equipment ready for Day 1?
- How will communication be coordinated across teams?



Feedback & Continuous Improvement

- What feedback methods will be used to evaluate onboarding?
- Who is responsible for reviewing and acting on feedback?
- What is the review cadence for updating onboarding practices?

Tips and Tricks



Start Early

Begin onboarding before Day 1 to build engagement and reduce anxiety.



Personalize the Experience

Tailor activities to the individual's role and background.



Leverage Technology

Streamline admin and provide easy access to resources.

What worked, against Claude

It reaches a launch-ready look much faster.

Both tools know what an onboarding tool should be. Lovable just ships the first prototype closer to something you could put in front of a customer. The deeper specifics still get added by hand, but the starting line is further along.

It shares Claude's core strengths. Plain-language editing, immediately visible clean instruction-following. On export, it goes a step further, with a full code workspace where you can browse the code in different formats before handing off to engineering.

Both tools produce something that actually works, not just a mockup. A new hire can open the agent, walk through the checklist, tick items off, and ask questions in chat. The boundary is one user at a time. If a second person opens the same link, they get their own independent copy, and the two never collide. That is enough for a guided walkthrough, a personal tracker, or a pilot with a single hire.

Where it breaks

The same wall. Lovable, like Claude, only builds what users see. Secure logins, user collaboration, and shared data that persists across people cannot be promissed into existence.

The free credits run out fast. Five daily credits did not cover one full round of building and refining. For comparison, the entire Claude build, opening prompt to final deployment across roughly eight rounds, used about a third of one session on the Claude Max tier.

The Bottom Line

Both tools build a working HR agent fast. Both take your follow-up instructions cleanly. The real question is what you are building it for.

Reach for **Claude** when you need a working proof of concept fast. To show a stakeholder how an idea would feel. To test the shape of a workflow. To prove it is worth real investment before anyone commits a budget to it.

Reach for **Lovable** when the output needs to look closer to a finished product. A launch-ready pilot, an internal rollout, and a polished demo to take outside the company.

Either way, hold one thing in mind. Neither agent talks to your ATS or HRIS directly on its own. Connecting to your live systems is a separate conversation with IT, Engineering, or your vendors, and it is the line where the afternoon project becomes a real job.

But here is the part that matters for the seat.

That is what gets the product approved.

And that is the part HR could never do before.

That's all for today.

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I'm Warren Wang, CEO at Doublefin.com | Ex-Google | Ex-Microsoft | Helping HR advocate for its seat at the table.



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